

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

we're encouraged to participate in the rat race, we really don't need to compare and compete with people whose origins and aspirations are wildly different from our own.

This isn't to say that it doesn't matter at all how you manage your money, only that you shouldn't be measuring your own financial success by the yardstick of a stranger on the internet. So, if we're not aiming for 'good with money', what are we aiming for?

That's right: financial wellbeing. We need to stop looking at external measures of how 'good' or 'bad' we are with money, and gauge our financial health by how successfully we're looking after our own financial wellbeing.

Changing how we measure our worth

We are all so much more than the sum of our parts. We exist, and our existence is valid and valuable no matter how good our relationship with money is. We know this, and yet we still look for external validation – for facts and figures and opinions that tell us we're doing okay, that we're worth something. That we're a good person. That we're well liked. That we're competent, clever, kind. I talk a lot throughout this book about the internal and external factors that influence our relationship with money, and the focus of this chapter is on learning how we can tame them both. How we can look at those external factors – our bank balance, feedback at work, guidance from professionals – and hold on to it only for as